XPortal AVETMISS NAT Files

Comprehensive Field Specifications

Technical Documentation for SMS Implementation

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Abstract

This document provides comprehensive specifications for all mandatory AVETMISS NAT files required for XPortal SMS system compliance. It details field requirements, data types, validation rules, and implementation guidelines for the Australian Vocational Education and Training Management Information Statistical Standard (AVETMISS).

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1 Introduction

The Australian Vocational Education and Training Management Information Statistical Standard (AVETMISS) requires Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) to submit data in specific NAT file formats. This document details the complete field specifications for implementing AVETMISS compliance in the XPortal Student Management System.

1.1 Document Purpose

This specification serves as the definitive guide for XPortal developers implementing AVETMISS NAT file generation and validation functionality.

1.2 NAT File Overview

AVETMISS requires 10 mandatory NAT files that capture comprehensive information about training organisations, students, programs, and training activities. All files must maintain strict referential integrity and follow precise formatting requirements.

1.3 Field Type Legend

- **A** = Alphanumeric field (letters, numbers, spaces, special characters)
- **N** = Numeric field (integers only)
- **D** = Date field (DDMMYYYY format)

2 NAT00010 - Training Organisation

2.1 Purpose

Contains basic information about the training organisation. **Exactly one record required.**

2.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier from training.gov.au
Training organisation name	A	100	Official organisation legal name
Training organisation type identifier	A	2	Type of training organisation (31=TAFE, 91=Private RTO, etc.)
Address building/property name	A	50	Building or property name
Address flat/unit details	A	30	Unit, flat, or suite details
Address street number	A	15	Street number
Address street name	A	70	Street name
Address suburb, locality or town	A	50	Suburb, locality, or town name
Postcode	A	4	Australian postcode
State identifier	A	2	State/territory code (01=NSW, 02=VIC, etc.)

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Telephone number	A	20	Primary contact telephone
Facsimile number	A	20	Facsimile number (may be blank)
Email address	A	80	Primary contact email address
Contact name	A	60	Primary contact person name
Statistical area level 1 identifier	A	11	ABS Statistical Area Level 1
Statistical area level 2 identifier	A	9	ABS Statistical Area Level 2

Table 1: NAT00010 Field Specifications

3 NAT00020 - Training Organisation Delivery Location

3.1 Purpose

Contains information about each location where training is delivered. **One record per delivery location.**

3.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier (matches NAT00010)
Training organisation delivery location identifier	A	10	Unique location identifier
Training organisation delivery location name	A	100	Location name or description
Address building/property name	A	50	Building or property name
Address flat/unit details	A	30	Unit, flat, or suite details
Address street number	A	15	Street number
Address street name	A	70	Street name
Address suburb, locality or town	A	50	Suburb, locality, or town name
Postcode	A	4	Australian postcode
State identifier	A	2	State/territory code

Table 2: NAT00020 Field Specifications

4 NAT00030 - Program

4.1 Purpose

Contains information about qualifications and courses offered. **One record per program/qualification.**

4.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Program identifier	A	10	Qualification/course code from training.gov.au
Program name	A	100	Full qualification/course name
Program level of education identifier	A	3	AQF level (e.g., C10=Cert I, C20=Cert II, etc.)
Program field of education identifier	A	4	ASCED field of education code
ANZSCO identifier	A	6	Australian and New Zealand Standard Classification of Occupations
ANZSIC identifier	A	4	Australian and New Zealand Standard Industrial Classification
Program recognition identifier	A	2	Recognition status (11=Nationally recognised, etc.)
VET flag	A	1	Y=Vocational Education and Training, N=Not VET
Nominal hours	N	4	Total program hours

Table 3: NAT00030 Field Specifications

5 NAT00060 - Subject

5.1 Purpose

Contains information about units of competency and modules. **One record per subject/unit.**

5.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Subject identifier	A	12	Unit of competency code from training.gov.au
Subject name	A	100	Unit of competency name
Subject field of education identifier	A	6	ASCED field of education code (6-digit)
VET flag	A	1	Y=Vocational Education and Training, N=Not VET
Nominal hours	N	4	Unit hours

Table 4: NAT00060 Field Specifications

6 NAT00080 - Client

6.1 Purpose

Contains student demographic and background information. **One record per student.** This is a critical file with privacy requirements.

6.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Client identifier	A	10	Unique student identifier (internal)
Name for encryption	A	60	**ENCRYPTED** student full name
Highest school level completed identifier	A	2	Highest school qualification (02=Year 12, etc.)
Gender	A	1	F=Female, M=Male, X=Intersex/Indeterminate, @=Not stated
Date of birth	A	8	DDMMYYYY format
Indigenous status identifier	A	1	1=Aboriginal, 2=Torres Strait Islander, 3=Both, 4=Neither, @=Not stated
Labour force status identifier	A	2	Employment status (01=Full-time, 02=Part-time, etc.)
Country identifier	A	4	Country of birth code (1101=Australia, etc.)
Disability flag	A	1	Y=Has disability, N=No disability, @=Not stated
Prior educational achievement flag	A	1	Y=Has prior qualifications, N=No prior qualifications
At school flag	A	1	Y=Currently at school, N=Not at school
Language identifier	A	4	Main language spoken at home
Unique student identifier	A	10	USI or exemption code

Table 5: NAT00080 Field Specifications

6.3 Critical Implementation Notes

- **Name encryption**: Student names must be encrypted before submission
- **USI requirement**: Most students require a valid USI
- **Privacy compliance**: Strict data protection requirements apply

7 NAT00085 - Client Contact Details

7.1 Purpose

Contains student contact information. **One record per student.**

7.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Client identifier	A	10	Student identifier (matches NAT00080)
Address building/property name	A	50	Building or property name
Address flat/unit details	A	30	Unit, flat, or suite details
Address street number	A	15	Street number
Address street name	A	70	Street name
Address suburb, locality or town	A	50	Suburb, locality, or town name
Postcode	A	4	Australian postcode
State identifier	A	2	State/territory code
Telephone number	A	20	Student contact phone
Email address	A	80	Student email address

Table 6: NAT00085 Field Specifications

8 NAT00090 - Client Disability

8.1 Purpose

Contains student disability information. **One record per declared disability type per student.**

8.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Client identifier	A	10	Student identifier (matches NAT00080)
Disability type identifier	A	2	Disability type code (11=Hearing, 12=Physical, etc.)

Table 7: NAT00090 Field Specifications

9 NAT00100 - Client Prior Educational Achievement

9.1 Purpose

Contains information about student's prior qualifications. **One record per prior qualification per student.**

9.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Client identifier	A	10	Student identifier (matches NAT00080)
Prior educational achievement identifier	A	3	Prior achievement type (A10=Cert I, B10=Cert II, etc.)

Table 8: NAT00100 Field Specifications

10 NAT00120 - Training Activity

10.1 Purpose

MOST CRITICAL FILE - Contains student enrolment and outcome data. This file controls all other file relationships. **One record per subject enrolment per student.**

10.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Training organisation delivery location identifier	A	10	Location identifier (from NAT00020)
Client identifier	A	10	Student identifier (from NAT00080)
Subject identifier	A	12	Unit identifier (from NAT00060)
Program identifier	A	10	Program identifier (from NAT00030)
Commencing program identifier	A	1	3=Commencing, 4=Continuing, 8=Subject-only
VET in schools flag	A	1	Y=VET in Schools, N=Not VET in Schools
Activity start date	D	8	Training commencement date (DDMMYYYY)
Activity end date	D	8	Training completion date (DDMMYYYY)
Delivery mode identifier	A	3	Delivery method (110=Classroom, 210=Electronic, etc.)
Outcome identifier national	A	2	Training outcome (20=Competent, 30=Not competent, 70=Continuing, etc.)
Funding source national	A	2	National funding type (11=Commonwealth, 13=Domestic full fee, etc.)
Funding source state training authority	A	3	State funding source
Client identifier apprenticeships	A	10	Apprentice identifier (if applicable)

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Associated course identifier	A	10	Associated course code
Scheduled hours	N	4	Scheduled training hours
Full-time identifier	A	1	F=Full-time, P=Part-time
Specific funding identifier	A	10	Specific funding contract
School level identifier	A	2	School level (if VET in Schools)
School type identifier	A	2	School type (if VET in Schools)
VET flag	A	1	Y=Vocational training, N=Not vocational
Predominant delivery mode	A	1	Primary delivery method

Table 9: NAT00120 Field Specifications

10.3 Critical Implementation Notes

- **Referential integrity**: All identifiers must exist in corresponding files
- **Date validation**: Activity dates must be logical and within collection period
- **Outcome codes**: Must align with actual training results

11 NAT00130 - Program Completed

11.1 Purpose

Contains information about completed qualifications. **One record per completed program per student.**

11.2 Field Specifications

lightgray **Field Name**	**Type**	**Length**	**Description**
Training organisation identifier	A	10	RTO identifier
Client identifier	A	10	Student identifier (from NAT00080)
Program identifier	A	10	Program identifier (from NAT00030)
Date program completed	A	8	Completion date (DDMMYYYY)
Issued flag	A	1	Y=Certificate issued, N=Not issued
Parchment number	A	25	Certificate/parchment number
Parchment issue date	D	8	Certificate issue date (DDMMYYYY)

Table 10: NAT00130 Field Specifications

12 File Format Requirements

12.1 Technical Specifications

- **File format**: Plain text (.txt) files only
- **Character encoding**: ASCII or UTF-8
- **Line endings**: DOS/Windows format (CRLF)
- **Field structure**: Fixed-width fields, no delimiters
- **No headers**: Data records only, no column headers

12.2 Naming Convention

Files must use exact naming convention:

- NAT00010.txt
- NAT00020.txt
- NAT00030.txt
- NAT00060.txt
- NAT00080.txt
- NAT00085.txt
- NAT00090.txt
- NAT00100.txt
- NAT00120.txt
- NAT00130.txt

12.3 Field Formatting Rules

- **Alphanumeric fields**: Left-justified, space-padded
- **Numeric fields**: Right-justified, zero-padded
- **Date fields**: DDMMYYYY format, no separators
- **Missing values**: Use appropriate codes (@, @@, etc.)

13 Validation and Compliance

13.1 AVETMISS Validation Software (AVS)

All NAT files must be validated through NCVER's AVS system before submission. The validation process includes:

- Basic format validation (field lengths, data types)
- Business rules validation (cross-file references, data logic)
- Compliance checks (mandatory fields, valid codes)

13.2 Critical Success Factors

1. **Data integrity**: Maintain referential integrity across all files
2. **Completeness**: Include all mandatory fields and records
3. **Accuracy**: Ensure data reflects actual training activities
4. **Timeliness**: Submit within required collection periods
5. **Privacy compliance**: Protect student personal information

14 Implementation Checklist for XPortal

14.1 Data Collection Requirements

Student personal details (NAT00080)

Student contact information (NAT00085)

Student disability information (NAT00090)

Student prior qualifications (NAT00100)

Training organisation details (NAT00010)

Delivery locations (NAT00020)

Program/qualification information (NAT00030)

Subject/unit information (NAT00060)

Training activity records (NAT00120)

Program completions (NAT00130)

14.2 System Requirements

USI integration and validation

Name encryption functionality

Fixed-width file export capability

Data validation routines

Cross-file reference checking

AVS integration for validation

Audit trail and reporting

14.3 Compliance Considerations

Privacy Act compliance

CRICOS requirements (if applicable)

State-specific reporting requirements

Data retention policies

Security and access controls

15 Conclusion

This specification provides the complete field requirements for implementing AVETMISS NAT file generation in XPortal. Strict adherence to these specifications is essential for AVETMISS compliance and successful data submission to national VET collections.

For additional support and the most current validation rules, consult:

- NCVER Portal: https://www.ncver.edu.au
- AVETMISS Validation Software: https://avs.ncver.edu.au
- Training.gov.au: https://www.training.gov.au